

BEFORE THE IOWA BOARD OF SOCIAL WORK

RE:
Social Worker Masters Level
License of

JANET GIDEON
License No. 081479
Respondent

CASE NO. 19-0178

**COMBINED STATEMENT OF
CHARGES, SETTLEMENT
AGREEMENT, AND FINAL ORDER**

COME NOW the Iowa Board of Social Work ("Board") and Janet Gideon ("Respondent"), and enter into this Combined Statement of Charges, Settlement Agreement, and Final Order ("Order") pursuant to Iowa Code sections 17A.10 and 272C.3(4), and 645 IAC 12. The Board has jurisdiction over Respondent and the subject matter of this case pursuant to Iowa Code chapters 17A, 147, 154C, and 272C, and 645 IAC 283.

A. STATEMENT OF CHARGES

COUNT I

1. Respondent is charged with engaging in sexual activities or sexual contact with a former client within five years following termination of the client relationship in violation of 645 IAC 282.2(9)"b", and may be disciplined pursuant to Iowa Code section 147.55(9) and 645 IAC 283.2(12).

B. FACTUAL CIRCUMSTANCES

2. Respondent holds Iowa license number 081479 to practice social work at the masters level, which is currently active through December 31, 2020.

3. From February 2018 to January 2019, Respondent provided therapy to a client.

4. In January 2019, Respondent entered into a sexual relationship with that client.

C. SETTLEMENT AGREEMENT AND FINAL ORDER

5. The Board has jurisdiction over the parties and the subject matter of this proceeding.

6. Respondent makes no admission of liability but acknowledges that the allegations in the Statement of Charges, if proven in a contested case hearing, would constitute grounds for the discipline agreed to in this Order.

7. Execution of this Order constitutes the resolution of a contested case. Respondent has a right to hearing before the Board on the charges, but Respondent waives the right to hearing and all attendant rights, including the right to appeal or seek judicial review of the Board's action, by freely and voluntarily entering into this Order. Once entered, this Order shall have the force and effect of a disciplinary order entered following a contested case hearing.

8. Respondent acknowledges that she has the right to be represented by counsel on this matter.

9. This Order is subject to approval by a majority of the full Board. If the Board does not approve this Order, it shall be of no force or effect to either party, and shall not be admissible for any purpose in further proceedings in this matter. If the Board approves this Order, it shall be the full and final resolution of this matter.

10. This Order shall be part of Respondent's permanent record and shall be considered by the Board in determining the nature and severity of any disciplinary action to be imposed in the event of any future violations.

11. Respondent understands the Board is required by federal law to report any adverse action to the National Practitioner Data Bank.

12. This Order, when fully executed, is a public record and is available for inspection and copying in accordance with the requirements of Iowa Code chapters 22 and 272C.

13. The Board's approval of this Order shall constitute a **FINAL ORDER** of the Board.

IT IS THEREFORE ORDERED:

14. Respondent agrees to **VOLUNTARILY SURRENDER** her social work license to resolve this matter. This voluntary surrender is considered discipline and, when accepted by the Board, has the same force and effect as an order of revocation under 645 IAC 12.1(5).

15. Respondent agrees not to use any words or titles which imply or represent that she is a licensed social worker, or to otherwise hold herself out to the public as a licensed social worker, or to engage in the practice of social work for which a license is required in the State of Iowa unless her license is reinstated.

16. Respondent shall immediately return her social work license to the Board.

17. Any request for reinstatement shall be governed by 645 IAC 11.31 and 280.15. Respondent's license shall not be reinstated except upon a showing by Respondent that the basis for the surrender of her license no longer exists, and that it is in the public interest for the license to be reinstated. Respondent understands that if an initial request for reinstatement is denied, the Board may establish requirements that must be met prior to considering a subsequent request. If Respondent's license is reinstated, Respondent understands it may be placed on probation, or otherwise restricted, and that the length of probation and the conditions of probation, or the terms of any restriction, will be established through further order of the Board in conjunction with an order granting reinstatement of Respondent's license.

18. Should Respondent violate the terms of this Order, the Board may initiate action to impose other licensee discipline as authorized by Iowa Code chapters 147, 154C, and 272C and 645 IAC chapters 13 and 283.

8/6/20

Date


JANET GIDEON
Respondent

This Combined Statement of Charges, Settlement Agreement, and Final Order is approved by the Iowa Board of Social Work on August 10, 2020.



Iowa Board of Social Work